

Capital letters

THE MOST COMMON USE OF A CAPITAL LETTER IS AT THE BEGINNING OF A SENTENCE.

In addition to starting sentences, capital letters are used for the names of people and places, and expressions of time, such as days of the week.

SEE ALSO

◀ 22–23	Nouns
◀ 34–35	Pronouns
◀ 68–69	Sentences
◀ 92–93	What is punctuation?
◀ 94–95	Periods and ellipses
Abbreviations	172–173 ▶
Making sentences interesting	184–185 ▶
Checking and editing	220–221 ▶

Starting a sentence

The first word of a sentence begins with a capital letter. This draws the reader's attention and emphasizes the beginning of the new sentence. A capital letter follows a period, an exclamation point, or a question mark at the end of the previous sentence.

On that

The first word in a sentence begins with a capital letter.

Expressions of time

Days of the week, months of the year, and national and religious holidays, such as Christmas, are all written with capital letters. However, the names of the seasons, such as winter, are never capitalized. Historical periods and events, such as the Industrial Revolution and the Olympic Games, are always capitalized.

Saturday

The days of the week are always capitalized.

Bronze Age

Both letters are capitalized for this historical period.

Halloween

Celebrations are always capitalized.

On **S**aturday afternoon in **O**livia as she hurried to meet her



- Remember to begin every **quotation** with a capital letter.

A, H, I, M, O, T, U, V, W, X,
and **Y** are all **symmetrical**
capital letters.

REAL WORLD

Capital letters and titles

The titles of books, plays, songs, newspapers, movies, and poems require capital letters. Smaller words within a title, such as the articles *a* and *the*, or the prepositions *of* and *in*, are not usually capitalized unless they are at the start of a title. For example, *The New York Times* spells *The* with a capital *T* because it is the first word of the newspaper's title.

